

F³ (F3) — Faster Financial Facilitation

Concept Note — Final Version

One-line pitch: Answer a few questions, get the three best options — across every category of bank and insurer — in one place.

F3 is a single destination for comparing and acting on financial products — deposits, investments, loans, and insurance — across every category of Indian bank and insurer, without making the customer wade through a spreadsheet to get there. It asks a short set of questions, then hands back a short, ranked answer.

Why F3. Faster, Financial, Facilitation — three F's, read as F³ ("F Cube"). It's also an honest description of how the product behaves: nothing in F3 shows more than three results at once, asks more than a couple of questions per step, or takes more than a few taps to reach an answer. The name carries the product's core discipline, not just its function.

Who it's for. Someone who already knows they should compare — an FD rate, a loan rate, a health cover — but today does it by opening four apps and two bank websites, or gives up and takes whatever their salary account bank offers. F3 does that comparison work, filtered to what actually applies to them, in the time it takes to answer three questions.

1. Design Principles

1. **Progressive disclosure, always.** Every screen shows the minimum needed to make the next decision. Nothing is dumped; everything is drilled into.
 2. **Ask before you answer.** No category opens straight into a data table. It opens into a short input step, because a rate only means something in the context of the customer's own amount, tenure, income, or location.
 3. **Three results, not thirty.** Every output screen defaults to a top-3 ranked list. "Compare all banks" is an explicit, secondary tap — never the default view.
 4. **One decision per screen.** Input steps ask for one or two related fields at a time, not a long form.
 5. **Category selection is visual, not numeric.** The home screen of each tab is a grid of icon tiles with a one-line description — no numbers, no rates, no bank names. Numbers appear only after the customer says what they need.
 6. **An escape hatch for power users.** Every input flow can be skipped ("Show me everything") for a customer who already knows what they want.
 7. **Learn once, reuse everywhere.** Inputs given in one tab (income, city, existing bank relationships) pre-fill relevant fields elsewhere, so nothing is typed twice.
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2. Banking Category — a cross-cutting filter

"Rates across all banks" currently treats every institution the same, but the type of institution changes what it's good for — and customers already think in these buckets. F3 surfaces this as an optional filter inside the input step, defaulting to "All," never as an upfront wall of data.

Category	Examples	Where it matters most
Public Sector Banks (PSU)	SBI, PNB, Bank of Baroda, Canara	Home loans, trust-sensitive FDs, salaried customers, govt-linked schemes
Private Banks	HDFC, ICICI, Axis, Kotak, IndusInd	Digital-first products, credit cards, premium banking
Small Finance Banks (SFB)	AU, Equitas, Ujjivan, Suryoday, Utkarsh	Highest FD rates, first-time/thin-file borrowers
Foreign Banks	Citi, HSBC, Standard Chartered, DBS	NRE/NRO banking, remittance, forex cards, HNI products
Cooperative Banks / RRBs	Regional/urban co-operative banks	Local reach, agri and rural lending
NBFCs	Bajaj Finserv, Tata Capital, HDB Financial	LAP, gold loans, SME/business loans, faster disbursal
Payments/Digital-first	Payments banks, fintech-partner banks	UPI-linked remittance, small-ticket savings

Not every product uses every category — the chips shown adapt to what's relevant (Foreign Banks and NBFCs don't appear as a filter for Mutual Funds; Cooperative Banks rarely appear for Bonds). Insurance uses a related but separate taxonomy — see Section 7.

3. Information Architecture

The four tabs stay as they tested — Invest, Expenses, Loans, Security. What changes is what sits inside each category.

4. Invest Tab

4.1 Fixed Deposits

- **Inputs:** Amount · Tenure · Senior citizen (Y/N) · Cumulative or payout · Bank category (chips, default All)
- **Output:** Top 3 ranked by **post-tax effective yield**, not headline rate. Badges: *Highest rate / Safest — PSU / Best for senior citizens*.
- **Drill-in:** TDS impact, premature withdrawal penalty, DICGC insurance confirmation (cover up to ₹5L).

4.2 Mutual Funds

- **Inputs:** Goal (Wealth growth / Tax saving / Short-term parking / Retirement) · Horizon · Risk appetite · Lumpsum or SIP
- **Output:** Top 3 curated funds for that goal/risk combination — 1/3/5-yr CAGR, expense ratio, risk grade.
- **Category filter equivalent:** Fund-house type — bank-sponsored AMC vs. independent AMC.

4.3 Bonds

- **Inputs:** Amount · Preferred tenure · Minimum rating (AAA / AA+ / Sovereign-only) · Issuer category (PSU / Corporate / NBFC)
- **Output:** Top 3 live investable bonds matching the filter, with YTM and rating badge.

4.4 IPO

- **Inputs (optional — skippable by default, since IPOs are time-bound):** Investor category (Retail/HNI) · Budget available
 - **Output:** Currently open + upcoming, price band, GMP, subscription %. Tap for an allotment-probability estimate.
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5. Expenses Tab

5.1 Transaction Analysis

- **Input:** Connect account or upload statement (one-time)

- **Output:** Category-level totals first. Tap a category to drill into merchant-level detail — never all merchants at once.

5.2 Best CC Selector

- **Inputs:** Top 2 spend categories (auto-suggested, editable) · Cards already held · Income bracket
- **Output:** One primary recommendation with the reason. "See alternatives" is a secondary tap.

5.3 Trip Planner

- **Inputs:** Destination · Dates · Number of travelers · Style (Budget/Comfort/Luxury)
- **Output:** Suggested budget split, plus a cross-link to the best forex card and travel insurance (pulls from Security tab).

5.4 Expense Planner

- **Inputs:** Monthly income · Fixed obligations (EMI/rent) · Savings goal %
- **Output:** Auto-generated category budgets, editable in place.

6. Loans Tab

All four loan categories share one input pattern, so the customer learns it once:

- **Inputs:** Loan amount needed · Purpose · Existing relationship bank (optional — unlocks pre-approved offers) · Employment type (salaried / self-employed / business) · Property or business location, where relevant · Bank category (PSU / Private / SFB / NBFC / Foreign)
- **Output:** Top 3 by **effective rate** (rate + processing fee amortized over tenure).
- **Drill-in:** EMI calculator. A soft eligibility check (no CIBIL impact) is offered as an explicit secondary action, never run automatically.

Loan type	Typical strength by bank category
HL / HL Overdraft	PSU banks often lowest headline rate; private banks faster processing
LAP / LAP Overdraft	NBFCs and private banks dominate, faster disbursal
LAS	Private banks and brokerage-linked NBFCs
WC / SME / Agri	PSU and cooperative banks for agri; NBFCs for fast SME working capital

7. Security Tab

Insurance uses its own institution taxonomy, presented the same way as bank category:

Insurer type	Examples
Public insurers	LIC, National, Oriental, GIC
Private insurers	HDFC Ergo, ICICI Lombard, Max Life
Standalone health insurers	Star Health, Niva Bupa
Bancassurance-tied	Sold through a specific bank's branch network

Each product has its own short input set — no generic "types" list is shown until the customer has answered:

- **Life:** Age · Cover amount needed · Term length · Smoker (Y/N)
- **Health:** Family size and ages · Existing conditions (Y/N) · City (affects room-rent norms) · Cover amount
- **Vehicle:** Vehicle type · Registration city · Insured Declared Value · No-claim bonus / claim history
- **Home:** Owned or rented · Structure value · Contents value · City (disaster-risk zoning)
- **Business:** Business type · Employee count · Cover type needed
- **Remittance:** Corridor (from-to country) · Amount · Frequency (one-time / recurring)

Output for each: Top 3 by premium/fee for the specific inputs given — never a generic list of "types."

8. Cross-Tab Intelligence

Because Expenses already captures income, spend pattern, and city, that data can pre-fill:

- Loan affordability estimates (Loans tab)
- Recommended life/health cover amount (Security tab)
- FD/MF suggestions sized to actual surplus, not a guess (Invest tab)

This is what keeps "ask before you answer" from becoming repetitive — F3 asks once per fact, not once per screen.

9. Visual Identity Note

The prototype's existing system — paper-green base, ink-navy structure, a lime accent,

Space Grotesk/Inter/IBM Plex Mono type — carries over unchanged; only the name and wordmark update. "F³" (F, superscript 3) reads cleanly as a monogram at app-icon size and reinforces the rule-of-three visually, without needing extra iconography.

10. Next Steps / Decisions Needed

1. **Name check.** F3 is short and memorable, but also a common alphanumeric string — worth a quick trademark and app-store-name search before lock-in (Formula 3 motorsport is the most likely collision).
2. **Data maintenance.** Bank- and insurer-category classification needs a maintained master list — RBI's SFB/PSU/Private classification does shift (e.g. universal banking license conversions).
3. **Personalization depth.** How much is auto-filled from a connected account vs. left as explicit, opt-in entry — a consent question as much as a UX one.
4. **Global vs. per-flow filter.** Should "Bank Category" be a persistent toggle across the app, or asked fresh inside each flow? Persistent is faster for repeat use; per-flow is clearer for first-time use.
5. **Skip-rate design.** Wording and placement of the "Show me everything" escape hatch will determine what share of customers use the guided flow vs. bypass it — worth testing both once live.